Housedge: what we started with, and what we added today

How the app worked this morning, what changed, and what is left. 26 October 2026.

In one paragraph. This morning Housedge was a well-built single-team tool. It ran as one server on Railway with one database file, it worked out what AI said about a brand mainly by counting brand names, and only our own team could log in. Today we built the foundation for selling it to many clients:

- a serverless backend on Supabase where each client can only ever see their own data;
- a much more accurate way of reading AI answers, with a quote as proof for every finding;
- client sign-up and a full onboarding questionnaire with file uploads;
- an admin console that shows every client's cost, results and satisfaction;
- "Run now" rebuilt on the new backend, with a live research screen.

The existing pages were kept as they were. Nothing has been committed or pushed yet.

22	20	~5,800	86
commits in the repo when we started (13–25 Oct)	existing files changed (+648 / −131 lines)	new lines: Supabase backend, new screens, tests	automated checks passing on Supabase (66 + 8 + 12)

1. What was in the repo this morning

The product. An "AI answer tracker". It asks AI assistants the questions a customer would ask (for example "What are the best food delivery apps in Finland?"), records each answer, and shows how often the client's brand appears compared with competitors, in what position and in what tone. It also listed the websites the AI cited, suggested actions, made reports, and had an "Optimise" section with a brand profile and ready-to-paste website code. It started on 13 October as a tracker for iGaming (casino and betting) brands and was opened up to any business later.

Browser
React app (22 pages), served by the same server.

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One server on Railway
Node.js + Express. All logic, logins, the daily schedule and running checks, in one process.

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One database file
SQLite on the server's disk, 20 tables.

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AI services
OpenAI, Google Gemini, Perplexity and Anthropic, with keys stored in the database.

How a check worked

1. "Run now", or a timer inside the server once a day, sent every question to each connected AI service.
2. Each answer was scanned for brand names using word matching plus a built-in list of known iGaming brands, and fixed word lists to guess tone ("best", "avoid"…).
3. The counts became the dashboard numbers: visibility (share of answers that mention the brand), position (order of first mention), sentiment and share of voice.

4. A "demo mode" could invent realistic answers so the app could be shown without paying for AI.

Accounts

One team (ours). Email and password with sessions; colleagues joined by invite link; a data key for Google Sheets. **Clients could not log in**: they saw reports we sent them.

What was good, and what held it back

GOOD (KEPT)	HOLDING IT BACK
• Clean, readable code with 67 passing tests. • Careful security basics: checked inputs everywhere, hashed passwords and links, safe handling of links found in AI answers. • Honest about what each AI service really is, and which ones cannot be tracked legally. • A polished interface with good charts and reports.	• **Accuracy:** counting names. It missed brands not in the list, counted words that only look like brand names, and treated "order mentioned" as "rank". • **Built for iGaming:** brand lists and website types were casino-specific. • **One process:** Railway's free tier sleeps when idle, and the schedule, running checks and limits lived in memory, lost on restart. • **No client accounts**, so no per-client separation, budgets or view of who costs what. • AI keys stored in the database next to ordinary settings.

2. What we added today

a. A far more accurate way to read AI answers

- **One method for every industry.** A small, cheap AI model (Claude Haiku) reads each answer and lists every company it names: recommended, just listed, compared, warned against, or mentioned in passing. It also records the brand's rank in a numbered list and its tone.
- **Proof for every finding.** Each brand comes with a sentence copied word for word from the answer. If the quote is not really in the answer, or the brand is not named in it, the finding is thrown out and counted. No more word lists or brand libraries.
- **Tested on real data:** 10 Wolt questions in Finland, compared old method against new, and Opus against Sonnet (two separate PDF reports). Reading costs about $0.001 per answer.

b. Cost decisions, based on measurements

USE	MODEL	COST PER ANSWER	WHY
Run now (someone is waiting)	Claude Sonnet, live	~$0.08	Fast and cheaper; chosen today.
Weekly scheduled checks	Claude Opus, batch	~$0.10	Best accuracy at half price; nobody is waiting.
Reading every answer	Claude Haiku	~$0.001	Matched bigger models on tracked brands.

c. New backend on Supabase (serverless, EU)

Browser
Same React app. Will be hosted on Vercel.

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Edge Functions
api (all pages and checks), *join* (accounts), *team* (admin actions). They run on demand and never sleep.

→

Postgres
Stockholm. Every row tagged with its company; the database itself enforces who sees what.

→

Storage + Anthropic
Private client files; AI key kept as a server secret, not in a table.

- **Security tests:**
  - 66 database checks prove that visitors, strangers, two different clients, team members and admins each see exactly what they should.
  - Account and data tests (8 + 12 steps) prove client A can never reach client B.
  - Supabase's own security scan shows one warning, a paid-plan feature.
- All existing pages now read from Supabase. They look the same.

d. Accounts and sign-in

ADDRESS	WHO	WHAT IT DOES
/onboarding	New clients	Create an account and company. An admin switch sets this to open (works at once), needs approval, or closed. New clients start with a $10 monthly AI budget, enough for a first check.
/login	Clients	Sign in. No sign-up link.

/admin/login	Our team	Team-only sign-in that goes to the admin console. Client accounts are refused.
/join/…	Invited people	One-time invite links made by an admin (expire after 7 days).

Passwords: 10+ characters with upper and lower case and a number. Public sign-up through Supabase is switched off; accounts are only created by our server. A clear "Sign out" button was added.

e. Client onboarding: everything we need from a client

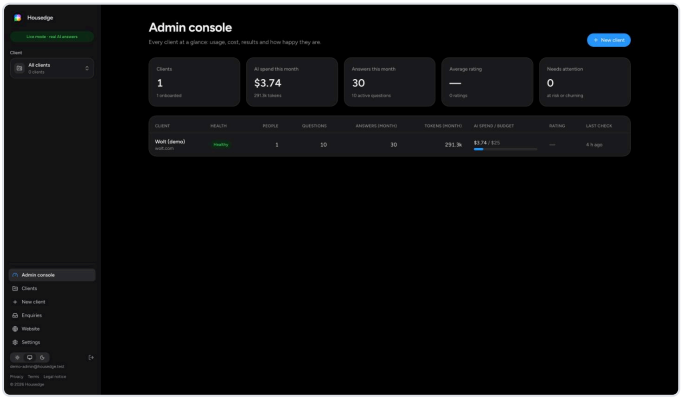
Nine steps after sign-up:

1. Company
2. Brand and other names
3. **About your business**: description, customers, products, prices, trust signals, legal name, founding year, headquarters, official profiles. This fills the Optimise brand profile automatically.
4. Competitors
5. Questions customers ask AI, in chosen markets
6. **Goals & contacts**: goals, what AI gets wrong about them, recent changes, main contact, who gets reports. This fills the team's Discovery notes.
7. **Files**: brand guidelines, logos, price lists, past reports. Up to 25 MB each, in a private folder only that client and our team can open.
8. AI assistants and schedule, with a monthly cost estimate
9. Review

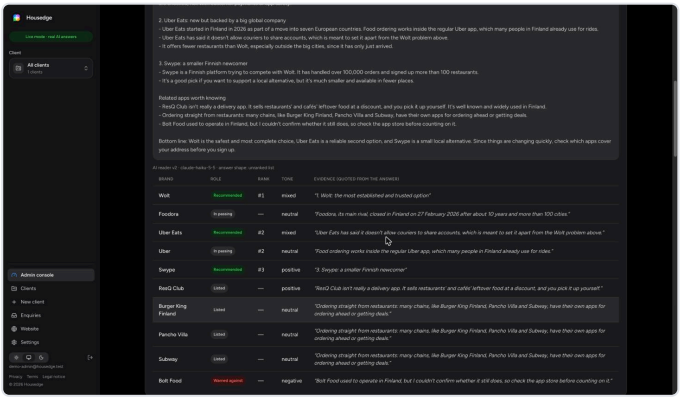
f. Admin console (/admin)

- All clients at a glance: health, people, questions, answers and tokens this month, AI spend against budget, average rating, last check.
- Self sign-up switch with Approve / Turn down for waiting sign-ups.
- Per client:
  - **Onboarding**: every questionnaire answer and file.
  - **Answers & findings**: every AI answer with cost, tokens, searches, and each brand found with its proof quote.
  - **Usage** by month and model, and **Ratings**: clients now rate each report 1–5 stars.
  - **People**: invite, reset link, remove.
  - **Account**: health and notes the client never sees, monthly AI budget, fee.

ADMIN CONSOLE



EVERY FINDING WITH ITS PROOF



g. "Run now" rebuilt on Supabase, with a live research screen

- **Before the first check:** a panel explains the three steps (ask, read, report) and shows the expected cost against the client's monthly budget. If no budget is set, it tells the client their Housedge contact will open it.
- **During a check:** a live screen lists every question with its state:
  - waiting;
  - asking Claude and searching the web;
  - reading the answer;
  - done, for example "Oura mentioned · #2 · also Samsung Galaxy Ring, WHOOP · 4 searches · 11 sources".

  A progress bar and timer run across the top. Results fill the dashboard when it finishes, and a report is made automatically.
- **Safe on spend:** the check will not start if it would go over the client's monthly budget. Every answer and reading is recorded with its exact cost.
- **Resilient:** if Supabase stops the background work at its time limit, the check carries on from where it stopped the next time the progress screen asks.

h. Smaller changes

- Figtree font everywhere.
- Removed the blue glow that followed the mouse.
- Clients land on their own dashboard and never see the team's sales board, client journey or discovery notes.
- All team pages live under /admin.
- The real Wolt test answers were loaded into a demo client.

3. Before and after at a glance

	THIS MORNING	NOW
Hosting	One server on Railway (sleeps on the free tier)	Supabase Edge Functions and Postgres (EU); front end ready for Vercel
Data	One SQLite file on one disk	Postgres with row-level security on every table (daily backups come with Supabase's Pro plan)
Who can log in	Our team only	Our team (/admin/login) and each client (/login), each limited to their own company
New clients	Set up by us by hand	Invite link, or self sign-up at /onboarding with a 9-step questionnaire and files
Reading answers	Counting names and word lists, iGaming brand library	AI reader for any industry, with a word-for-word quote as proof
Cost control	One global monthly cap	A budget per client, checked before every check; cost recorded per answer

Seeing our clients	No overview	Admin console: spend, tokens, results, ratings, health, every answer
AI keys	Stored in the database	Server secret on Supabase
Tests	67 on the old server	71 on the old server + 86 checks on Supabase

4. Status and what is next

STATUS	WHAT
Working and tested	Supabase database and security; invites; admin console; all existing pages; report rating; onboarding (first version walked through with Wolt).
Built today, first real test is yours	Self sign-up (/onboarding), the 9-step questionnaire with files, /admin/login, sign-up approvals, the Onboarding tab, and **Run now with the live research screen**. Try it with the Oura demo: a check of Oura's 15 questions costs about $1.30 of its $10 monthly budget.
Not yet	• Weekly scheduled checks (timer plus half-price batches). • ChatGPT, Gemini and Perplexity: they need their API keys added. • Website check, fact check and AI draft pages. • Sending invite, approval and reset emails automatically (needs an email service). • Moving existing clients from Railway. • Hosting the front end on Vercel (Pro plan, about $20/month, for commercial use).

Nothing has been committed or pushed. Demo accounts and data (Wolt demo, Oura) live in the Supabase project and can be removed before go-live. Detailed reports from today: docs/wolt-test/Wolt-accuracy-test.pdf, docs/wolt-test/Wolt-sonnet-tests.pdf, docs/Housedge-progress-supabase.pdf.